

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

MSI GeForce FX 5600 128MB

Authoritative performance

The FX5600-VTDR128 is based on nVidia's FX5600 chipset. As usual, MSI's offering is packed to the gills with free games, remote control, VIVO connectors, composite and S-video cables, etc. To top it all, you also get two software discs—Restore-It and WinDVD.

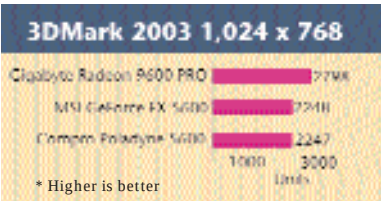


The installation was hassle free. The card runs at a core clock speed of 325 MHz, while the memory clock speed is 275 MHz with a memory bandwidth of 8.8 GBps. This card supports DirectX 9, so you can happily play all the up and coming games, with all the eye-candy turned on too.

We ran the usual assortment of tests on this card, and boy did this card run them. If you want to play all your favourite games at high resolutions, this card will definitely not disappoint you. Though our performance winner in the last comparison—the Gigabyte 9600 PRO—remained the top scor-

er in all the tests, the MSI did give it some close competition. The Gigabyte soared in the 3DMark 2003 tests with a score of 2798, while the MSI scored only 2248, but the MSI maintained a lead of about 29 fps in the *Serious Sam* and *Quake III Arena* tests.

Overall, the Gigabyte card just about managed to hold on to its crown, as the MSI is a great product. However, they need to revise the price of the GeForce FX 5600 if they want to make an impact. We suggest you wait a bit till the price drops before snatching up this beauty.



SPECIFICATIONS

GeForce FX 5600 chip;
325 MHz core clock speed;
275 MHz memory clock;
1.3 billion texels/sec fill-rate;
DX9/OpenGL 1.4 compliant

Price: Rs 13,000
Contact: Cyberstar Infocom Ltd
Phone: 080-2276986/ 226781
E-mail: narend@cyberstarin.net
Web site: www.msi.com.tw

MSI GeForce FX 5600 128MB		B+
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Build quality	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	

Monarch MV-20

Precious moments on DVD

The MV-20 is an affordable and versatile video capture card. It offers support for capturing videos directly to DVDs. It has both S-video in and out connectors, and also Composite in and out connectors. Stereo mini jacks are provided for audio line-in and line-out. With such an assortment of connectors, you can do professional-level video editing with ease.

The card can take video input from the either a VCR or your DV camera, and transfer the video to your computer. You can then save it in a format of your choice. The options provided are quite a few, including MPEG-1, MPEG-2 and DVD PAL. After you capture the video, you can edit it using the bundled Ulead VideoStudio software. The software offers numerous effects and transitions that you can apply with ease. You can also edit the audio to make it more professional. The application interface is pretty straightforward.

You can also take snapshots of your videos, which you can use to make jewel cases, or view as a slideshow. This is especially useful for

video professionals who make marriage and other family function videos. To put all this on to a DVD, Monarch uses



the Ulead DVD MovieFactory software. The application pops up when you click the Make DVD/VCD button, and all you need to do is follow the instructions.

With this card, you can also connect your VCR or DV Camera to a computer, and watch the output on TV while the card does its job. Such functionalities will definitely be appreciated by users and professionals alike, especially at its reasonable price.

SPECIFICATIONS

Output formats: DVD, VCD and SVCD, onboard brightness, contrast, hue and saturation controls, 2 RCA jacks for Composite, 2 for S-video, 2 3.5 mm stereo audio jacks.

Price: Rs 14,800
Contact: Monarch Video Vision
Phone: 022-2261 9022
Fax: 022-2261 8706
Email: viren@bom2.vsnl.net.in
Website: www.monarchvision.com

Monarch MV-20		B+
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	